

Alta Scuola Politecnica
22nd cycle - Spring School 2026
Design Methods and Processes

Students' essay

Course	
Title	Design Methods and Processes
Essential Note	Please read the assignment carefully: in past years, most essays that received insufficient marks did so because they did not address the assignment requirements adequately.
Assignment	Students are expected to demonstrate that they can understand and interpret a design research paper on a specific topic and critically discuss its findings in relation to their own design experience. Each student has been assigned one research paper (see attachment). Please structure your essay as follows: a. Summarize the assigned paper, focusing on its main original contribution. This section should not exceed one quarter of the total essay length. b. Discuss the key message of the paper and explain how it relates to the content delivered during the school lectures. At minimum, your discussion must explicitly address the connections between the assigned paper and the DM&P lectures held on 14 March and 18 April 2026. This section is essential for demonstrating achievement of the learning objectives and should account for approximately half of the essay. You should refer to the course content broadly; relying on only one or two isolated lectures will be considered limited fulfilment of the course objectives. c. Reflect on your personal experience as a designer, either within ASP or in your previous studies. To what extent does your experience align with the findings of the assigned paper? Which of the authors' conclusions are supported by your experience? Are there aspects of your experience that challenge or contradict their claims? d. (optional, extra) Building on your reflections, identify any aspects that would merit further investigation. Propose a possible extension of the study presented in the paper that could generate new insights into design processes. You are expected to suggest a research activity, not to carry it out. General requirements Essays must comply with the highest standards of academic integrity. All sources of data and information must be properly cited and included in complete references. Submissions will be checked with anti-plagiarism software, including tools for detecting AI-assisted paraphrasing.

	If you use any AI tools while preparing your essay, you must explicitly disclose this at the end of the document. The disclosure must specify which tools you used, what prompts or requests you submitted, and how the tools contributed to your work.
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